Tomislav Mesarić

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PROFESSIONAL SUMMARY

Butcher and meat-counter professional with experience since 2015 in carcass breakdown, portioning, fresh sausage production and customer service. Skilled in beef, pork and lamb preparation, FIFO stock rotation, cold-chain temperature checks and hygienic equipment cleaning. Holds a vocational butcher certificate and a current basic HACCP food hygiene certificate.

PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

Butcher, Mesnica Kod Ante (family butcher shop), Zagreb *2019–Present*

- Break down 2–3 beef forequarters and 10–12 pork sides per week; bone, trim and portion meat for the counter.
- Produce four fresh sausage varieties using the shop's recipes; make about 40 kg per week in the busy season.
- Developed the shop's lamb merguez recipe and adjusted the ćevapi mix to 70% beef and 30% lamb following customer feedback; the ćevapi won second place at the 2023 Zagreb County craft meat fair.
- Record cold-room and display-counter temperature checks twice daily, maintaining cold-room temperatures at 0–4 °C.
- Rotate cold-room stock every morning using FIFO, placing the oldest products at the front.
- Serve about 120 customers on Saturdays and advise on cuts and cooking times.
- Trained two apprentices in knife handling and cleaning routines.
- Prepare whole lambs and suckling pigs for spit-roasting at weddings and family parties; ordered, butchered, seasoned and delivered the meat. Largest order: four lambs and two pigs for a 180-guest wedding in 2024.
- Ran a six-week dry-ageing trial of beef ribs, recording weight loss and temperature; the shop now sells dry-aged rib by pre-order.

Counter Assistant, Tržnica Dolac meat hall stall, Zagreb *2015–2019*

- Served customers, weighed and priced orders, operated the till and completed cash-up.
- Cleaned and sanitised slicers, mincers and the counter at close.
- Wrote a one-page closing and cleaning checklist following a hygiene inspection remark; it remains in use at the stall.

EDUCATION AND CERTIFICATES

Vocational certificate: Butcher, Food Trades School Zagreb, 2015 (3-year programme)
HACCP basic food hygiene certificate, 2021; renewed 2024
Preparing for the master butcher exam (majstorski ispit), planned for spring 2027

SKILLS

Carcass breakdown (beef, pork and lamb); boning and trimming; meat portioning; fresh sausage making; knife sharpening; mincer and bandsaw operation; FIFO stock rotation; cold-chain temperature checks; HACCP hygiene records; equipment cleaning and sanitising; customer advice; cash handling

LANGUAGES

Croatian (native); English (good); German (basic)